

JAMES MITCHELL

Bristol, United Kingdom

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a full stack engineer with 12 years building scalable systems across finance and SaaS sectors. I've led technical decisions on infrastructure and architecture, mentored junior developers, and shipped features that handled millions of daily transactions. I thrive in environments where I can solve complex problems with practical solutions rather than chasing trends.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Velocity Labs

velocitylabs.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the redesign of our payment processing infrastructure, reducing latency by 40% and cutting infrastructure costs by £180k annually through optimized database indexing and caching strategies

Established code review standards and automated testing practices that improved deployment frequency from bi-weekly to daily while maintaining zero critical incidents in production

Mentored 5 junior and mid-level engineers through pairing sessions and architectural discussions, with 3 promoted to senior roles within 18 months

Architected a real-time analytics pipeline handling 2 billion events monthly using Apache Kafka and PostgreSQL, enabling product teams to make data-driven decisions

Senior Full Stack Engineer

Fintech Solutions Ltd

fintechsolutions.co.uk

Bristol, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Built and maintained microservices architecture supporting regulatory-grade financial transactions for 50+ enterprise clients using Node.js and Python

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting systems using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to incident detection from 45 minutes to 5 minutes

Drove migration from monolithic Rails application to distributed services, improving system reliability from 99.2% to 99.95% uptime over 18 months

Collaborated with compliance and operations teams to design audit logging systems that satisfied FCA requirements without impacting application performance

Full Stack Developer

Digital Forge Ltd

digitalforge.net

London, United Kingdom

August 2012 - May 2017

Developed customer-facing web applications using React and Express.js for 15+ client projects ranging from startups to mid-market companies

Managed PostgreSQL and MongoDB databases, handling schema migrations and performance optimization for applications serving up to 500k monthly active users

Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Docker, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 15 minutes and enabling safer release cycles

Participated in on-call rotation supporting production systems across 8 different applications, responding to incidents and implementing permanent fixes

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

2010 - 2012

BSc Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

2007 - 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, SQL, Ruby, Go

Frontend: React, Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3, Webpack, Redux

Backend: Node.js, Express, Django, Rails, FastAPI

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform

DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Terraform

Tools: Git, JIRA, Datadog, Apache Kafka, nginx